CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
Knight Center, 655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305
christiankontz.com ◇ ckontz@stanford.edu

EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
Dissertation Committee: Hanno Lustig (chair), Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru, Juliane Begenau

Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

University of Hamburg *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial Intermediation, Corporate Finance, Climate Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing

JOB MARKET PAPER

- *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
  Awards: Winner of FIRS 2025 Conference Prize for PhD Students and SFS Cavalcade 2025 PhD Student Award
  Media: Bloomberg's Matt Levine Money Stuff Newsletter

WORKING PAPERS

1. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]
   Awards: Winner of UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025, GRASFI Conference 2024 Best PhD Paper Award, Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize, FIRS 2024 Conference Prize for PhD Students

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *From Markets to Meters: How Index Investing Affects Utility Rates*
2. *The Cross-section of Prices* with Hanno Lustig and Miguel Chumbo
3. *Does Index Investing Lower Expected Returns? Evidence From Option Markets*
4. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

PRESENTATIONS (⋆SCHEDULED, ^{c}CO-AUTHOR)

AFA Annual Meeting⋆ *2026*

Johns Hopkins Carey Finance Conference, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (UHH), SFS Cavalcade, FIRS Conference, Four Corners Conference on Indexing, Investment Company Institute, Northeastern Uni Finance Conference, UIC Finance Conference^c, AFA Annual Meeting (2x Poster) *2025*

FIRS Conference, SoFiE Conference, GRASFI Conference, OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable Financial Intermediation, FMA Conference, MFR Summer Session for Young Scholars (Poster), UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo), Citadel^c *2024*

Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, USC Marshall PhD Conference, MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster), UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty, and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School *2023*

German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW) *2022*

OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

US Census Bureau *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

University of Chicago *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

Princeton University *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

University of Hamburg *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Base Finance, TA to Juliane Begenau	*2022, 2023*
Capital Markets and Institutional Investing, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall	*2023, 2024, 2025*
Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy, TA to Amit Seru	*2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
Debt Markets, TA to Darrell Duffie	*2021, 2022*
Modeling for Investment Management, TA to Steven Grenadier	*2023, 2024, 2025*

University of Hamburg

Macroeconomics 1 (UG), TA to Kristin Paetz	*2016*

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Shortlisted for Brandes Center Prize 2024	*2025*
UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2025*
SFS Cavalcade PhD Student Award	*2025*
Stanford GSB Academic Career Advancement Fellowship	*2025-2026*
Finalist 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition (FIASI)	*2025*
American Finance Association Travel Grant (AFA Annual Meeting)	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2024*
Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize	*2024*
GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award	*2024*
Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business	*2020–2025*
Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University	*2018–2020*
Undergraduate and Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2015–2018*

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: Journal of Finance, Management Science
Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Media: Frankfurter Allgemeine (in German)

Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)

BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*) *2011–2014*
Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant) *2009–2011*

REFERENCES

Hanno Lustig (primary advisor)
The Mizuho Financial Group Professor of Finance
Stanford Graduate School of Business
655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305
hlustig@stanford.edu

Amit Seru
Steven and Roberta Denning Professor of Finance
Stanford Graduate School of Business
655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305
aseru@stanford.edu

Monika Piazessi
Joan Kenney Professor of Economics
Stanford Department of Economics
579 Jane Stanford Way, Stanford, CA 94305
piazzesi@stanford.edu

Juliane Begenau
Associate Professor of Finance
Stanford Graduate School of Business
655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305
begenau@stanford.edu